VerdaGrow

Vertical Farming Technology for Urban Food Security in MENA — Projected ARR: USD 500,000 by December 2025

CONFIDENTIAL INVESTMENT MEMORANDUM

Sector	AgriTech
Stage	Pre-seed
Geography	MENA
Funding Ask	USD 600,000

Executive Summary

VerdaGrow designs and operates modular vertical farming units for deployment in urban centres across the MENA region. Each VerdaGrow unit produces leafy vegetables and herbs year-round using 95% less water than traditional field agriculture. We sell produce directly to supermarket chains and hotel groups under long-term supply agreements. Founded in 2023 by Antoine Berbiche, VerdaGrow is pre-revenue and seeking its first external funding round to build and deploy its first commercial unit in Tunis.

Problem

MENA imports over 60% of its food supply, making the region highly vulnerable to global commodity price shocks and supply chain disruptions. Arable land in MENA is diminishing due to desertification and urban sprawl. Water scarcity makes traditional agriculture increasingly unviable: MENA has less than 1% of the world's freshwater resources. Urban populations are growing rapidly, creating urgent demand for locally produced food.

Solution

VerdaGrow's modular farming units (8m x 12m shipping container footprint) are deployable in any urban location with electricity and water access. Each unit produces 22 tonnes of leafy greens per year. Our proprietary nutrient delivery system uses 95% less water than soil farming and eliminates pesticide use entirely. Pricing: long-term supply contracts with supermarket chains at EUR 4.20 per kg, representing a 35% premium to imported produce based on freshness and local branding.

Founding Team

Name	Role	Background
Antoine Berbiche	Founder & CEO	Agricultural engineer with 6 years experience in greenhouse operations in the Netherl

VerdaGrow currently has no board of directors, no advisory board, and no co-founders. Antoine Berbiche is the sole founder and sole decision-maker for all company matters. The company plans to recruit a CFO and a Head of Operations post-funding.

Market Sizing

The global vertical farming market is large and growing very rapidly. MENA has a significant food import dependency problem that vertical farming is uniquely positioned to solve. Our target customers are major supermarket chains and hotel groups in Tunis, Casablanca, and Cairo. We believe VerdaGrow can capture a meaningful share of the premium fresh produce market in these cities within three years.

Revenue Model & Traction

B2B supply agreements with supermarket chains and hotel groups. Pricing: EUR 4.20 per kg of produce delivered. Each deployed unit generates approximately EUR 92,400 in annual revenue. VerdaGrow targets deploying 6 units in Year 1, scaling to 30 units by Year 3.

Metric	Current Value
Revenue to Date	USD 0 (pre-revenue)
Letter of Intent Received	1 (Monoprix Tunisia — informal expression of interest)
Units Deployed	0 (first unit under construction)
First Unit Completion Target	Q4 2024

Competitive Differentiation

Competitor	Key Weakness vs VerdaGrow
Imported produce (main competition)	Long supply chains; high price volatility; poor freshness on arrival
Bowery Farming (US)	US-only operations; not designed for MENA climate or regulatory environment
Local greenhouse operators	High water usage; pesticide dependency; limited to rural land

Milestones

Date	Milestone
Jan 2023	Company registered in Tunisia; EUR 30K personal savings invested
Jul 2023	Site secured in Tunis industrial zone; first unit frame ordered
Dec 2023	Informal letter of interest from Monoprix Tunisia received
Q4 2024	First commercial unit operational; first supply agreement signed
2025	Scale to 6 units; first year of commercial revenue

ESG, Governance & Financial Projections

Environmental Commitments

VerdaGrow's vertical farming technology will reduce carbon emissions by 70% compared to conventional imported produce supply chains, accounting for transportation, packaging, and cold storage elimination. Our units eliminate pesticide use entirely and will achieve net-zero water consumption through closed-loop recycling. VerdaGrow is positioning itself as one of the most environmentally positive food production companies in the MENA region and will be a significant contributor to regional sustainability goals.

Social Commitments

VerdaGrow contributes to food security for urban MENA populations. By producing fresh vegetables locally, we reduce MENA's food import dependency and create local agricultural employment. Our units will create 3–5 operational jobs per deployed farm. We are committed to responsible employment practices.

Governance

VerdaGrow is a sole-founder company at this stage. Antoine Berbiche is the sole director and decision-maker. Financial records are maintained by the founder using standard accounting software. An external accountant will be engaged post-funding.

Financial Projections

VerdaGrow projects significant revenue growth following the deployment of our first commercial units. Given the strong demand for locally grown fresh produce in MENA supermarkets and hotel groups, we are confident in achieving our Year 1 revenue target of USD 300,000 in our first full year of operations, scaling to USD 1.8 million by Year 3 as the unit fleet grows.

Metric	Year 1 (2025)	Year 2 (2026)	Year 3 (2027)
Units Deployed	6	15	30
Revenue (USD)	300,000	700,000	1,800,000
Gross Margin	38%	44%	52%
Operating Burn (USD)	480,000	320,000	—

Use of USD 600K Pre-seed: 60% first commercial unit construction and fitout, 25% nutrient delivery system procurement, 15% working capital and operations.